Lesson 28: Cohesion 2: Demonstratives, Summary Nouns and Links Between Paragraphs

English Stage 3 (C1) · Unit 3: Paragraphs, Essays and Cohesion

Adapted from Reading, Writing, Research, and Reasoning: An Advanced ESL Text by Gabriel Winer and Elizabeth Wadell, ASCCC Open Educational Resources Initiative (CC BY-NC 4.0): 2.9 Demonstrative Pronouns; 2.10 Demonstrative Adjectives + Summary Nouns; 2.12 Creating Cohesion between Paragraphs; 2.13 Language Toolkit; 2.14 Takeaways.

In this lesson

You learn to point back to earlier ideas with "this" and with a demonstrative + summary noun ("these perspectives", "this problem"), and to connect body paragraphs with transitions and bridges. You also collect useful phrases for topic sentences, quotations and concession, and review the chapter. These tools make a long academic text easy to follow.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Use "this" as a demonstrative pronoun to point back to the idea of the previous sentence.
- Use a demonstrative adjective + summary noun to sum up a complex idea in a few words.
- Connect body paragraphs with transition words and bridges in the topic sentence.
- Use toolkit phrases to write topic sentences, to explain and analyse quotations, and to write concessions.
- Name the book's five ways to create cohesion within a paragraph.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
demonstrative pronoun	*this, that, these, those* used alone, in place of a noun	"One reason for **this** is that they get less recognition from peers."
demonstrative adjective	*this, that, these, those* before a noun	"**these** fields"
summary noun	a noun that sums up a longer idea mentioned earlier	"this **concept**" = implicit bias
implicit bias	"subconscious attitudes that inform how we think and behave towards others"	the topic of the Smith and Gayles paper
bridge	words in a topic sentence that connect a paragraph to the one before it	"In addition to [last paragraph], another benefit of X is ..."

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
concession	admitting that an opposing view has some truth	"While it is true that ..., this is not a major disadvantage because ..."
implication	a meaning or result that is suggested, not stated	"One implication of [Author]'s view is that ..."
explicitly	clearly and directly	"Although [Author] does not explicitly say so, we can assume that ..."

Rules and explanations

"This": a finger pointing back

- Demonstrative pronouns point out a specific thing: *this/these* for things that are close, *that/those* for things far away.
- Readers cannot see you point, so in academic writing a demonstrative pronoun works like a finger **pointing backwards** to an earlier idea in the paragraph.
- *It* is not a demonstrative pronoun, so it does not point back like a finger. *That* is for things far away. To show a **close** connection between sentences, academic writers use **this**.
- Each "this" sums up the complex idea of the previous sentence in one simple word and shows how the ideas are connected.

Useful phrases: "This shows that ..."; "One example of this is ..."; "The implication of this is ..."; "This means that ..."; "From this, we can assume that ..."; "This is because ...". Choose a phrase that fits the meaning of the sentence.

Demonstrative adjective + summary noun

A demonstrative adjective (*this, these*) describes a noun instead of replacing it. Together with a **summary noun**, it points back to an earlier idea and sums it up in one short noun, reminding the reader concisely of what came before.

Common summary nouns (Table 2.10.1): this advantage / these advantages; this belief / these beliefs; this cause / these causes; this concept / these concepts; this experience / these experiences; this issue / these issues; this problem / these problems; this situation / these situations.

- "Implicit bias refers to unconscious ideas about groups of people. **This concept** can explain some of the challenges faced by women in the engineering field."
- "Stereotypes are common. It would be difficult to eliminate **this problem**, but that does not mean we should not try."

Cohesion between paragraphs

Transitions in topic sentences. Start each new body paragraph with a transition in its topic sentence, for example in an essay with four body paragraphs, including a concession:

- The first reason that ...

- Another reason is that ...
- The most significant reason that ...
- Although some argue that [opposing view], it is crucial that we consider [my opinion].

Bridges. Use your words to connect one body paragraph to the next:

- Repeat key words from the previous paragraph in the topic sentence of the next paragraph.
- Include the idea of the previous paragraph in the topic sentence of the next one:
  - In addition to [last paragraph], another benefit of X is [new paragraph topic].
  - Despite the advantages of [last paragraph], this has not been implemented because of [new paragraph topic].
  - As a result of [last paragraph], [new paragraph topic].
  - Though [last paragraph] is well-known, fewer people recognize [new paragraph topic].

The bridge must match the real relationship between the two paragraphs. If you cannot see how two paragraphs are connected, you may need to reorganize them, or add a concluding sentence to the first one.

Language toolkit for body paragraphs

Purpose	Phrases
Topic sentences	One [significant/main/major/key] [benefit/advantage] is ... · One [significant/main/major/key] reason ... is that ... · Another positive aspect of X is ... · The second main [cause for/problem with/effect of] ... is ... · In order to solve this problem, it is important to ...
Explaining a quote or example (after the quote)	In other words, [his/her/their] point is ... · As this quote/example shows, ... · Basically, [Author] is saying ... · [Author]'s point is that ... · The essence of [Author]'s argument is that ...
Analysing quotes	One implication of [Author]'s view is that ... · Although [Author] does not explicitly say so, we can assume that ...
Concession topic sentences	However, not everyone agrees that ... For example, ... · On the other hand, some people say that ... For example, ... · Some may object to the idea of ... because ...
Responding to a concession	While it is true that ..., this is not a major disadvantage because ... · However, it is important to also consider the fact that ...

You will study concession in Lesson 44.

Unit review

You have now written an introduction with a thesis, body paragraphs (topic sentence, evidence, analysis) and a conclusion, and you know five ways to create cohesion: transition words, known-to-new structure, demonstrative pronouns, demonstrative adjectives + summary nouns, and parallel structure.

Small mistakes in the lesson material

The second author's name is **Gayles** (not "Gales" or "Gasten Gales"). "how we they think" should be "how we think"; "To some up" should be "To **sum** up"; "Table 2.6.3.1" is Table 2.10.1; in the Vietnamese paragraph, "criminals that, and" has an extra "that".

> **Note for Arabic speakers** - Arabic demonstratives change for gender and number; English demonstratives change only for number. Use *this/that* with singular and noncount nouns (this concept, this information) and *these/those* with plurals (these fields). Avoid "this fields" and "these informations".

Practice

Exercise 1. One word for every blank. Read the paragraph in "Checking what you know about academic demonstrative pronouns" ("The first way that stereotypes affect women in STEM fields ...").

1. Which one word fits all three blanks? Why are *it* and *that* not the best choices?
2. What does each of the three blanks point back to?

Exercise 2. Adding cohesion with "this". In the paragraph about international students from Vietnam ("Recently, some Asian countries like Korea and Japan ..."), add some of the "this" phrases. Make sure each phrase fits the meaning.

Exercise 3. Summary nouns in a published paper. In the three paragraphs by Smith and Gayles ("Implicit bias refers to ..."), what does each phrase in brackets sum up?

1. these perspectives
2. these fields
3. these concepts

Exercise 4. Adding a summary noun. Increase the cohesion of the paragraph in "Adding demonstrative adjectives + summary nouns for cohesion" ("One of the main reasons that stereotypes are hard to erase ...") with a demonstrative adjective + summary noun from Table 2.10.1.

Exercise 5. Bridges between paragraphs. Look again at the three Smith and Gayles paragraphs.

1. How does the first sentence of the third paragraph ("While each form of bias ...") connect it to the two paragraphs before it?
2. The second paragraph begins: "Sexual harassment refers to direct or indirect sexual conduct that is not welcomed." Rewrite this as a bridge topic sentence that links back to the first paragraph (implicit bias), using one of the book's patterns.

Exercise 6. Explaining and analysing a quote. In the STEM paragraph (Exercise 1), the writer explains the quotation from Smith and Gayles with this sentence: "In other words, there may be subtle discrimination and female students may not get the recognition that they deserve from male classmates."

1. Which part of the language toolkit does "In other words" come from?

2. Write another sentence that explains the same quotation, with a different toolkit phrase.
3. Write one sentence that analyses it, with a phrase from "Analysing quotes".

Speak with your tutor

- "Ask me the Takeaways questions one at a time (for example: How does a strong thesis affect the rest of an essay? Which cohesion methods are new to me?). Correct my English after each answer."
- "Here are the sentences in my essay that start with This: [paste]. Is it clear what each one points to? Where would a summary noun be clearer?"
- "Here is my essay: [paste]. Look at the last sentence of each body paragraph and the first sentence of the next. Do they lead into each other smoothly? Where do I need a bridge?"
- "Give me a paragraph from a PSYC 110 reading. I will find its cohesion methods: transition words, known-to-new order, demonstratives with summary nouns, parallel structure. Then tell me what I missed."
- "Check my answers to Exercises 4 and 5."

Read aloud

Stress the demonstrative and the summary noun (in bold).

1. One reason for **this** is that they get less recognition from peers.
2. **This** means that women who want to be engineers are already facing bias before they even start work.
3. Over time, **these perspectives** lead to unfair judgments.
4. Implicit bias refers to unconscious ideas about groups of people. **This concept** can explain some of the challenges faced by women in the engineering field.
5. I realized that I had made a wrong judgement in both situations. **These experiences** led me to reflect on my own biases.

Writing task

Revise your whole essay draft (Lessons 24 to 27) for cohesion within and between paragraphs. With a new topic, revise any essay of three or more paragraphs you have written (for example on stereotypes, or on a PSYC 110 topic such as social influence).

1. In each body paragraph, add one or two "this" phrases ("This shows that ...", "This means that ...") or a demonstrative + summary noun where a sentence depends on the idea before it.
2. Check every "this" in your essay: is it clear what it points to? If not, add a summary noun.
3. Underline the last sentence of each body paragraph and the first sentence of the next. Do they lead into each other? If not, rewrite the topic sentence as a bridge, add a concluding sentence, or reorganize.
4. After each quotation, add a sentence of explanation and, where useful, a sentence of analysis, using the toolkit phrases.

Self-editing checklist:

- Every *this* points clearly to one idea in the sentence before it.
- *This/that* go with singular and noncount nouns; *these/those* with plurals.
- Each summary noun matches the idea it sums up (a problem is a problem, a cause is a cause).
- Each body paragraph's topic sentence shows how it connects to the paragraph before it.
- Each quotation is followed by an explanation in my own words.
- My essay uses several of the five cohesion methods, not only transition words.

Paste your draft into the chat and ask your tutor for feedback. Then rewrite it.

Watch online

- Kathleen N. Smith and Joy Gaston Gayles, "'Girl Power': Gendered Academic and Workplace Experiences of College Women in Engineering" (the free, open-access research paper quoted in this lesson): https://www.mdpi.com/2076-0760/7/1/11/htm

Answer key

Exercise 1 (book)

1. **this**. *It* is not a demonstrative pronoun, so it does not point back to an earlier idea. *That* refers to things far away, but the writer wants to show a close connection between the sentences.
2. (a) Women feeling unwelcome in their classes. (b) Subtle discrimination, and female students not getting the recognition they deserve. (c) People imagining engineers as men, and women being assumed to be a little less competent.

Exercise 2 (example answer; sentences 1 and 3 do not change) "... **This is because** universities believe that most Vietnamese students go there just to work and illegally stay there. ... **This shows that** in their eyes, we are nothing but poor and uneducated people. **The implication of this is that** people believe that Vietnamese are poor or even criminals, and somehow it has become the only story about my country."

Exercise 3 (book)

1. "stereotypes and preconceived judgments about various groups of people"
2. "science and engineering fields"
3. "each form of bias": the two forms discussed earlier, implicit bias and sexual harassment

Exercise 4 (example answer; sentence 1 does not change) "... **This concept** refers to biases that we do not recognize we have, and that may even be against our own conscious ideas about groups. We learn **these beliefs** early in life from our families, education, and the media. Since the media is one of **these causes**, it is important to analyze how the media portrays different groups so that biases don't continue to spread." (Other choices that fit the meaning are also correct, for example "To address **this problem**, it is important to analyze ...".)

Exercise 5

1. It includes the ideas of both earlier paragraphs in one phrase, "each form of bias" (implicit bias and sexual harassment), and then states the new topic: the negative effects on women in engineering (like the pattern "Though [last paragraph] ..., [new paragraph topic]").
2. (example answer) In addition to implicit bias, another form of bias that women in engineering face is sexual harassment, which refers to direct or indirect sexual conduct that is not welcomed.

Exercise 6

1. "Explanation of quote or example (use after the quote)".
2. (example answer) Smith and Gayles's point is that the work of female engineering students often goes unnoticed by their male teammates.
3. (example answer) Although Smith and Gayles do not explicitly say so, we can assume that this lack of recognition may make some women feel less confident about staying in engineering.

My notes